When I was first shown the movie's depiction of this, I was pleased to discover that Paul Franklin's team got it right, and also got right something I had missed: In the movie, the image of the universe above is surrounded by Gargantua's accretion disk (Figure 28.3). Can you explain why this must be so?

Cooper sees all this above him, but he doesn't see the infalling singularity. It is moving downward toward him at the speed of light, chasing but not catching the light rays that bring him images of the disk and universe above.

Because we are rather ignorant of what goes on inside black holes, I told Chris and Paul that I'd be comfortable if they used their imaginations in depicting what Cooper sees coming up at him from below, as he falls. I made only one request: "Please don't depict Satan and the fires of Hades inside the black hole like the Disney Studios did in their *Black Hole* movie." Chris and Paul chuckled. They weren't tempted in the least.

When I saw what they did depict, it made great sense. Looking downward, Cooper should see light from objects that fell into Gargantua before him and are still falling inward. Those objects need not emit light themselves. He can see them in reflected light from the accretion disk above, just as we see the Moon in reflected sunlight. I expect those objects to be mostly interstellar dust, and this could explain the fog he encounters in the movie as he falls.